

Childhood crushes reconnect in college with different approaches to love.

EXT. PUBLIC TRANSPORTATION STATION - DAY

Autumn touches up her hair and makeup while nonchalantly leaning against a metal pole.

A tall figure approaches and she squints before scrambling to put her stuff away.

Warren approaches and the two struggle between a dap up, a hug, a handshake, and a fist bump. They side hug.

Autumn
Hey! How are you?

Warren
I'm good. This is crazy, though.

Autumn
Yeah, thanks for coming to pick me up.

Warren
No problem. I parked over there.

Autumn
You drove?

Warren
Yeah.

Autumn
Oh, nice. You brought a car.

Warren
Eh, something slight, you know. Do you wanna grab coffee?

Autumn
Sure.

INT. Warren'S JEEP - DAY

Shot inside of the car, the two enter from opposite sides.

Autumn

It's crazy, it's been so long.

Warren

Yeah, I haven't seen you in a minute.

Autumn

You aren't 5 foot 4 anymore.

Warren

And you're not a 4 anymore.

Autumn

I wish we still knew each other so I could smack you.

Warren

I feel like it's coming anyway.

Autumn laughs familiarly.

Autumn

So, how do you like school? In state and all. Still seeing our old history classmates?

Warren

Eh, I mean. I see Edward now and then. Do you know anything about him?
I'm nosey.

Autumn

I somehow know less than you.

Warren

Doubt that's possible. I'm really just a student here to be a student.

Autumn

Me too. It's starting to be a problem how little I study.

Warren

Yeah, I don't study period. I'm only in one class right now.

Autumn

What? You're actually a bum? Did you drop out or something?

Warren

Nah.

Autumn

Do you have a start-up or something? How is that possible?

Warren

Nah. I can't have a little business on the side?

Autumn

What the hell are you alluding to?

Warren laughs almost silently, letting the pause linger.

Autumn

Are you a drug dealer? You can just tell me if you're a drug dealer.

Warren contemplates. Then, relents.

Autumn

Why are you gatekeeping? Just tell me.

Warren

This is so embarrassing.

Autumn

I promise you I'm the last one to judge.

Warren

I make kid's video games.

It's silent and Warren is unreadable waiting for her reaction. She slowly swivels her head towards him and erupts in excitement.

Autumn

Are you serious, dude? That's so fucking cool.

Warren

I mean, maybe to the nine year olds that play with the flying pickle swords.

Autumn

Who cares? The age of their parents' money doesn't matter.

Warren

I guess. I didn't even last 30 minutes.

Autumn

Why would you? Holy shit. You really never know what people are up to.
Your parents are okay with this?

Warren

They weren't at first. I had to program at 2am so my dad wouldn't see.

Autumn

But they came around?

Warren

Yeah, once I told him he wouldn't have to pay for my college, he stopped complaining. But school will always be there. I can come back when I want.

Autumn smooths out her outfit and fidgets in her seat.

Autumn

That's insane. Congrats, dude.

Warren

How's your school? An Ivy, isn't it? The East Coast and everything.

Autumn

I mean, nothing as exciting as that. I just drink and party.

Warren

At least you go outside.

Autumn

Hey, we're both outside right now.

Warren

New experience for us both.

Shot of the two entering Warren's room for a tour. Autumn puts down a half-drunken frappuccino.

Autumn immediately hops onto the bed.

Autumn

Not too shabby. Thought it'd just be a mattress and some lotion on the bed.

Warren

I clean up nice.

Warren plops down beside her. There is a somewhat awkward gap between the two. An awkward long tension holds as they avoid eye contact with one another.

Warren

It's crazy, you were my crush in 9th grade.

Autumn

That's not crazy. I liked you since 5th. We talked everyday, then you ghosted me, actually. I even gave you a written note before you got on the bus before summer. Probably threw it away, didn't you. Little shit.

Warren

I did?

Autumn

Yeah. I'm still mad.

Warren

Aw, come on, I was like 10.

Autumn

Me too.

Warren

Sorry.

Autumn

Whatever, just come here.

They are kissing and Autumn is sitting on Warren. Warren pulls away.

Warren

You're so high up.

Autumn

Let me get closer.

Warren

Sorry , I haven't done this in a while.

Autumn

Me too. Actually, that's not true. But it's been like,
Autumn starts counting on her fingers. She hesitates after two.

Autumn
Well, it hasn't been a proper sesh-

Warren (breathy and with a smile)
I don't care.

They begin kissing again.

Autumn
Could 5th grade you have ever guessed this would happen?

Warren
I mean. Yeah.

Autumn
You're seriously telling me elementary-school-you could've imagined
your beef jerky poking up against me 10 years later?

Warren
Why do you always gotta put it like that? No, bruh!

Autumn (jokingly)
Oh, so you always thought I was easy.

Warren
No. Not that.

There's a pause as the two try to decipher what's unspoken.

Warren
What'd you think of me, though? Am I different than what you
expected?

Autumn
You're a lot funnier than I remember. You came out of your shell. You
were practically mute before.

Warren
What can I say? I get that a lot.

Autumn

That you were mute?

Warren

No, that I'm a hilarious guy.

Autumn

Oh. Nancy paid me to say that.

Warren

You remember my mom's name?

Autumn

I always remember my business transactions.

Warren

You're not too bad yourself.

Autumn

Thank you so much, Warren. That's the highest praise I've ever received.

Warren

No problem, Autumn. You're really brightening my day.

Autumn

Tell me something I don't know.

Warren smiles at her.

Autumn

Let's take this off.

She removes Warren's shirt, then her own. He is hot and her eyes widen. They continue kissing.

Autumn

Wow. I still can't believe this is real. Didn't you have a girlfriend?

Warren

Huh? Right now?

Autumn

Yes. Let me know when she's coming back home so she won't shoot me on the spot. No, dummy. Before this.

Warren

Oh, yeah. It would be concerning on my end, too. Uh, yeah, I did.

Autumn

So... how was that?

Warren

It was nice. Long-term.

Autumn

Why'd it end?

Warren

I broke up with her before college. She doesn't even go to this school.

Autumn

You didn't wanna do distance?

Warren

Nah, she's in Seattle. I just knew it was time.

Autumn

How'd you know?

Warren

I just did.

Autumn looks slight hurt and pauses. She retreats slightly.

Autumn

Oh. I see. I wonder if she knew.

The two look at each other. Warren looks almost inquisitive. Autumn seems guarded.

Warren

So why'd you hit me up then?

Autumn

Just curious how you were.

Warren

Really.

Autumn recovers her playful demeanor. She begins tracing his abs.

Autumn

Well, I was honestly coming for this part, but the catching up has been better.

Warren

Right.

Kissing again.

Autumn

Why'd you say yes?

Warren

I was curious about you, too.

Autumn

Ah, not for the sex.

Warren

There are things more special than that.

Resume kissing.

Autumn

Would you ever live on the East Coast?

Warren

I have it too good here to move away forever.

Autumn

Oh, I get that.

Autumn goes for a kiss.

Warren

Are you never coming back to Seattle?

Autumn

I mean, maybe a summer house. I couldn't live here.

Warren

I get that, too.

There is an awkward pause and they look into each other's eyes. Autumn can't help but rub her thumb across his cheek. Warren looks away.

They pull away and demount. They grab their shirts and put them back on. Sitting on the bed beside each other, slowly adjusting to laying down with somewhat awkward expressions.

The two talk more and end up just laying on the bed talking to each other until the sun goes down in the window behind them. Autumn checks her phone and realizes she has to go again.

[CUE MUSIC]

She stares at Warren for a long while while he's asleep and does a series of activities, yearningly

1. Plays with his hair while holding his head
2. Slowly releases him
3. Looks at him longingly
4. Fake strangles him
5. Squeezes his biceps
6. Squints at him
7. Rubs his cheeks with her thumb

The camera shoots a close-up of her lips puckered, approaching his forehead from a side-angle before pausing. Her lips leave the frame and the camera refocuses on her conflicted expression.

8. Goes in for a forehead kiss then retracts it
9. Lays idly and looks to the ceiling

Reaches chorus as she writes a paper note. Different montages of her writing notes, ripping them out, crinkling them up and throwing them in her purse. She leaves the half empty notepad on the counter. She hesitates for a long while before pressing the pen hard into the paper and writing her final short note with pain on her face. She leaves one note on his desk.

She sneaks out of the door and a crumpled paper note full of ink falls from her bag onto the floor just outside the doorway as the door closes behind her in slo-mo. The shot smoothly switches to the paper on his dark desk right as it hits the ground, showing her note firmly on his desk before rolling credits.

"HAGS - Autumn T"